

LELAND COMMUNITY UNIT SCHOOL DISTRICT NO. 1
BOARD OF EDUCATION
REGULAR MEETING – MEDIA CENTER
370 NORTH MAIN STREET, LELAND, IL 60531
FEBRUARY 20, 2019 - 7:00 p.m.

1. CALL TO ORDER

President Plote called the regular meeting to order at 7:05 p.m.

2. ROLL CALL

Present: Anderson, Kinney, Riskedal, Shumway, Todd, Wold and Plote

Absent: None

Also in attendance were Administrators Jodi Moore, Chris Bickel, District Bookkeeper Jason Zaleski and Recording Secretary Andrea Niles.

3. PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE

4. BOARD SALUTES

Salutes include the following: Mrs. Anderson gave a shout out to Leland United Methodist Church for hosting the recent cooking class put on by the CIA. Mr. Riskedal thanked the school, Mr. Miller, Mr. Bland, and Mr. Bickel for all their work helping put together this year's Pinewood Derby. He said it was a well-attended event and there were 108 cars that raced this year. Mr. Bickel announced the students that received Student of the Month honors for December/January: 3rd grader Isabelle Wilkinson, 7th grader Malayna Kinney, and Sophomore Emma Roth. He also gave a shout out to Rylie Donahue our school representative at the LaSalle County Spelling Bee and this year's Middle School Science Fair winners: with Honorable Mention:

1. Grace Ackerman
2. Austin Todd
3. Brooklynn Guede

The winners that will be advancing to the next round of competition:

3rd place - Curtis Serby

2nd place - Porter Thrall/Alex Todd

1st place - Malayna Kinney with her project: *What makes a cut flower live longer?*

Mr. Riskedal commented he was really impressed and appreciated all of the students that participated in the science fair. Mr. Bickel said this was the first year 6th grade students participated in projects and gave kudos to Miss Rissman and Mrs. Jansen for all their work with the Science Fair.

5. OPEN FORUM

President Plote welcomed LEA representative Kelsey Stegman. Other visitors included Stu Bloom.

There was no open forum discussion.

6. APPROVAL OF CONSENT AGENDA

Wold moved and Todd seconded the motion to approve the consent agenda as follows:

6.1 Regular Meeting Open and Closed Session minutes from January 16, 2018.

6.2 Monthly Bills for January and February as presented.

Ayes: Anderson, Kinney, Riskedal, Shumway, Todd, Wold and Plote.

Nays: none

MOTION CARRIED on 7-0 vote.

7. APPROVAL OF 2019-2020 DISTRICT CALENDAR

Anderson moved and Kinney seconded the motion to approve the proposed 2019-2020 district calendar.

Mrs. Moore reminded the Board it is possible the calendar may have to be changed once ISBE opens their site and gives a clear definition of what an attendance day will be required to include. Mr. Bickel reported LEA approved leaving two evenings open for parent teacher conferences as requested by the Board at last month's meeting. Union members asked the district to do a parent survey in the future to obtain feedback from parents what would work best for them.

Ayes: Kinney, Riskedal, Shumway, Todd, Wold, Anderson, and Plote.

Nays: none

MOTION CARRIED on 7-0 vote.

8. APPROVAL OF BUS LEASE

A motion was deferred until all information was presented and discussion followed.

Riskedal moved and Todd seconded the motion to approve a bus lease with Central States Bus Sales, Inc. for a 3-year lease on 3 full size busses, as well as a used, 2016 microbus on a 5-year lease.

Mr. Bickel presented information/quotes from two companies on full size and activity busses, with pricing on gas and diesel options with one- and three-year lease agreements. Midwest Transit Equipment currently only has diesel full-sized busses available. The proposals include an updated security camera system. He noted our current camera system is 10+ years old and needs updating. The cost in the quotes includes approximate \$2,500 for each bus to update the system. The 3-year lease options all include routine maintenance. Central Bus gave pricing on a new and used 14-passenger bus with a 5-year lease. The Board requested Mr. Bickel inquire why the lease price on a 3-year gasoline

71 passenger bus was moderately higher than a 3-year lease of a diesel 71 passenger bus, whereas the gasoline busses on the 1-year (and 2-year) lease options were slightly lower than the diesel.

Ayes: Riskedal, Shumway, Todd, Wold, Anderson, Kinney and Plote.

Nays: none

MOTION CARRIED on 7-0 vote.

9. APPROVAL OF RESOLUTION FOR FEASIBILITY STUDY

Wold moved and Riskedal seconded the motion to approve recommended resolution for participation in a consolidation feasibility study with Somonauk Community School District 432.

This Resolution for a Feasibility Study provides an opportunity for discussion, and clarifies by open vote, the collective intention of the Board to enter a feasibility study with Somonauk.

Mrs. Moore reported Somonauk Board of Education had a limited Board at their last monthly meeting, and therefore did not have an action item to vote on joining a feasibility study with Leland. She also reminded the Board this step does not commit the District fully to a feasibility study just yet.

Mr. Shumway expressed concern particularly in the areas of Leland's academics. He would like to see us further develop and improve our current course offerings so that we "have something we can bring to the table" moving forward. Response to his concern included Mrs. Plote indicating that by adding our facility to the big picture, there is more physical room for growth; Mrs. Anderson added that there would be the supplemental financial backing by our taxpayers; Mrs. Moore incorporated to that the advantages of the additional enrollment. Mr. Shumway is worried about proceeding too quickly before the District is fully ready to commit, fearing the Board would have a limited number of chances to "sell" the idea to the community.

President Plote reiterated the three main purposes, or focuses, of a feasibility study:

- 1) To clarify the financial perspective of the district.
- 2) To improve and expand curriculum options.
- 3) To improve and expand extra-curricular offerings.

Ayes: Todd, Wold, Anderson, Kinney, Riskedal and Plote.

Nays: Shumway

MOTION CARRIED on 6-1 vote.

10. APPROVAL OF FEASIBILITY STUDY PROPOSAL

Wold moved and Riskedal seconded a motion to amend the dates listed on the presented proposal to conduct a consolidation feasibility study between Leland CUSD 1 and Somonauk CUSD 432.

The Board would like the dates amended on the submitted proposal to state:

Effective Dates of contract: Start Date: *This study will start no later than June 30, 2019.*

The current proposal states:

Effective Dates of contract: Start Date: March 10, 2019 **End Date:** June 30, 2019.

MOTION CARRIED 7-0 on a voice vote.

Riskedal moved and Anderson seconded the motion to approve the presented proposal to conduct the consolidation feasibility study between Leland CUSD 1 and Somonauk CUSD 432.

Mrs. Moore contacted ISBE per Board recommendation to gather names of consultants to request proposals for the consolidation feasibility study. With the names given, one set of partners reached out to Mrs. Moore and Mr. Streicher of Somonauk and expressed interest in submitting a proposal. This motion is to accept this proposal as presented to the Board.

Ayes: Todd, Wold, Anderson, Kinney, Riskedal and Plote.

Nays: Shumway

MOTION CARRIED on 6-1 vote.

11. APPROVAL OF APRIL MEETING DATE CHANGE

Anderson moved and Riskedal seconded the motion to approve changing the regularly scheduled Board of Education meeting from Wednesday, April 17th to Monday, April 15 at 7:00pm in the Media Center.

This has been discussed at previous Board meetings, however, no action was taken to set a new date.

Discussion included it being more beneficial to schedule the meeting the following week to Wednesday, April 24 at 7:00pm in the Media Center. This date falls within the 30-day requirement to seat newly elected Board members.

MOTION FAILS on 0-7 vote.

Shumway moved and Kinney seconded the motion to approve changing the regularly scheduled Board of Education meeting from Wednesday, April 17th to Wednesday, April 24 at 7:00pm in the Media Center.

MOTION CARRIES on 7-0 vote.

12. APPROVAL OF ADMINISTRATION REPORT

Anderson moved and Riskedal seconded the motion to approve the Administration Report as presented by Mr. Bickel.

Beginning in January, the after school homework help program was changed to include students in grades 3-12 only. Teachers and aides felt the time was too unproductive for the younger students and there were not enough resources to fill that role. The focus needed to be brought back to homework and missing work assistance. Attendance at the 3-5 level has remained fairly consistent thus far. At the middle and high school levels, attendance has greatly increased due to a stricter staff monitoring of students on the D/F list. There has already been an increase in completion of work and therefore a decrease on the D/F list. Also, there are now learning trackers in place for these students. Students with a D or an F in a class, meet with that teacher and go over assignments missed or struggled on. The student then reflects on their lack of progress with the teacher and then they work to put a plan in place to help them bring their grade up.

Mr. Bickel reviewed for the Board the current status of weather-related emergency days this year. So far six emergency days for extreme weather have been called in addition to one late start and two early dismissal days due to weather. An amended calendar shows the last day of student attendance to be May 31st and teacher institute day June 3, 2019. Only 5 days are required to be made up per ISBE.

Mrs. Stegman will again be hosting the One School, One Book program through the Media Center. The book has been chosen but not yet released. Last year's family participation was very positive. The program will begin in April and conclude with a celebration on May 3rd.

Mr. Bickel shared with the Board facility usage by community groups/organizations and private families has greatly increased. Our current system had a simple sign out form. We presently do not charge a fee to use the facilities at Leland School, however, charging a refundable deposit is being considered. Mrs. Niles and Mr. Bickel worked to create a new sign up agreement with guidelines/rules for participants wishing to use District facilities. He shared a link to the agreement with the Board.

During a school committee review, Mr. Bickel shared the Parent/Student Handbook committee has begun meeting to make proposed changes to the current handbook. A major focus is on the discipline procedures section. He reminded Board members they are welcome to join the committee if desired. Another committee that has recently met is a newly formed DREAM BIG committee. The primary focus of this committee is to improve the overall environment and culture of the building.

Important Dates

2/21/19 Course Selection Night

3/1/19 End of MS 2nd Trimester

3/5/19 Little 10 Band Festival

3/8/19 Jr. Class Trivia Night

3/15/19 Active Shooter Training

5/9/19 - Community Awards Night

Ayes: Wold, Anderson, Kinney, Riskedal, Shumway, Todd, and Plote.

Nays: none

MOTION CARRIED on 7-0 vote.

13. DISCUSSION OF DISTRICT GOALS - MID-YEAR REVIEW

The 2018-2019 District Goals as approved by the Board at the August 2018 meeting were presented for review and discussion. Mrs. Moore informed the Board the Student Assistance Program is being revitalized with the inclusion of Mrs. Hall, school social worker and Mr. Epperson, school guidance counselor. In regards to FINANCES she said tuition reimbursement for staff members can no longer be Title II funds since the reimbursement was included in the Collective Bargaining Agreement reached earlier in the year.

There was no further discussion on the 2018-2019 District Goals.

14. DISCUSSION OF 3-YEAR REGIONAL OFFICE OF EDUCATION COMPLIANCE VISIT

During the recent 3-year compliance visit, initial reports are favorable, stating the District had very well prepared and presented data. A formal, final report will be presented to the District and Mrs. Moore will share that with the Board for approval once it is received. A couple notables included the office needs to include student SIS (State Identification) numbers on all transcripts. Also, all Board of Education members are mandated reporters to DCFS and will need to sign a form acknowledging this. There was no further discussion on the compliance visit.

15. DISCUSSION OF IASB STARVED ROCK DIVISION MEETING

The meeting will be held Tuesday, March 12 at Peru High School. There is no cost to attend, however, attendees need to register online. There will be desserts provided, as this is no longer a dinner meeting. The program title this year is: "Funding, Student Success, and the Future - An Update on EBM, ESSA, and Vision 20/20". Mrs. Plote indicated interest in attending and Mrs. Moore said the Board of Education candidates for the upcoming election have expressed interest in attending.

16. EXECUTIVE SESSION

Wold moved and Todd seconded the motion to go into executive session to discuss matters related to employee performance as it relates to the appointment, employment, compensation, discipline, performance, or dismissal of specific employee of the public body or legal counsel for the public body, including hearing testimony on a complaint lodged against an employee of the public body or against legal counsel for the public body to determine its validity. Also, for matters related to litigation, when an action against, affecting or on behalf of the particular body has been filed and is pending before a court or administrative tribunal, or when the public body finds that an action is probable or imminent, in which case the basis for the finding shall be recorded and entered into the minutes of the closed meeting.

In addition, there will be discussion on employee performance concerns, which could potentially impact course scheduling, discussion on entering an agreement with Somonauk CUSD 432 for hiring a shared Ag teacher for the 2019-2020 school year. This will be an action item in March. Administration evaluations will be discussed during closed session, as well.

Ayes: Anderson, Kinney, Riskedal, Shumway, Todd, Wold, and Plote

Nays: none

MOTION CARRIED on 7-0 vote and the meeting entered closed session at 8:07pm

Riskedal moved and Wold seconded the motion to return to open session.

MOTION CARRIED on 7-0 voice vote and the meeting re-entered open session at 8:40 pm.

17. APPROVAL OF PRINCIPAL EVALUATION

Riskedal moved and Kinney seconded the motion to approve the Principal's evaluation.

Ayes: Kinney, Riskedal, Shumway, Todd, Wold, Anderson and Plote

Nays: none

MOTION CARRIED on 7-0 vote.

18. APPROVAL OF SUPERINTENDENT EVALUATION

Riskedal moved and Wold seconded the motion to approve the Superintendent's evaluation.

Ayes: Riskedal, Shumway, Todd, Wold, Anderson, Kinney and Plote

Nays: none

MOTION CARRIED on 7-0 vote

19. ADDITIONAL ACTION ITEMS RESULTING FROM EXECUTIVE SESSION

No additional action items resulting from executive session.

Mr. Bickel and Mrs. Moore presented information and led discussion on entering an agreement with Somonauk CUSD 432 for hiring a shared Ag teacher for the 2019-2020 school year. Mr. Bickel will continue to collect more information.

20. ADJOURNMENT

Wold moved and Riskedal seconded the motion to adjourn.

On a voice vote, the MOTION CARRIED 7-0.

Meeting adjourned at 8:47pm.

Janet Plote, President

Claire Anderson, Secretary